

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Drupal Expert with over 9 years of experience developing and architecting scalable, secure, and high-performance Drupal platforms. Proficient in building custom modules, theming with Twig and Sass, integrating APIs, and leading technical teams. Skilled in PHP, JavaScript, REST/JSON APIs, and MySQL/PostgreSQL with a strong understanding of Drupal 9/10/11. Adept at performance optimization, Drupal security, and Agile project delivery. Passionate about open-source contribution and advancing development standards through mentorship and collaborative teamwork.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Drupal:** Custom module development, theme creation, entity management, taxonomy, Migrate API, JSON:API, REST, caching, security hardening
- **Languages:** PHP (advanced), JavaScript (jQuery, ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Sass/Less
- **Frontend:** Twig, React, Vue.js (basic familiarity), Bootstrap, responsive design
- **Backend:** PHP OOP, custom Drupal services, Symfony components
- **Database:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, query optimization, MariaDB
- **DevOps/Tools:** Git, Composer, Docker, PhpStorm, VS Code, Drush
- **Architecture:** MVC, microservices, design patterns, reusable components
- **Methodologies:** Agile, Scrum, CI/CD, JIRA, Confluence, Test-driven development
- **Soft Skills:** Mentoring, technical leadership, client communication, estimation & prioritization

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Architected and implemented high-performance Drupal 10-based SaaS platforms by developing custom modules, decoupling services, and streamlining caching to support over 500K monthly users.
- Led the upgrade of legacy Drupal 8 systems to Drupal 10, ensuring API integrity, backward compatibility, and full regression coverage through automated and manual testing.
- Integrated JSON:API endpoints with external systems including payment processors, CRM tools, and analytics dashboards, ensuring real-time synchronization and secure token-based access.
- Developed custom Drupal themes using Twig, Sass, and responsive grid frameworks, ensuring full WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility compliance and pixel-perfect design fidelity.

- Created robust migration pipelines with Migrate API, successfully importing over 1 million content records from legacy CMS systems with mapping, transformation, and rollback features.
- Spearheaded Drupal performance optimization initiatives including Varnish configuration, view caching strategies, and PHP opcode tuning, resulting in 60% load time reduction.
- Mentored junior developers in Drupal coding standards, module architecture, and Composer-based workflows, contributing to faster onboarding and reduced code review times.
- Collaborated in Agile sprints as technical lead, providing estimations, risk analysis, and architecture documentation while ensuring timely sprint delivery and stakeholder alignment.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Built custom Drupal 8 modules to support real estate listing systems, integrating mapping APIs, multilingual support, and advanced filters tied to taxonomy structures.
- Developed Drupal themes using Twig, Bootstrap 4, and Sass for desktop and mobile-first responsive UI across customer-facing portals and B2B back-office platforms.
- Integrated CRM systems and marketing automation tools using custom RESTful services, synchronizing contact forms, campaign data, and client workflows.
- Automated deployment pipelines using Git, Docker, and shell scripts to streamline environment setup and reduce QA feedback cycle from days to hours.
- Enhanced Drupal's search functionality using Apache Solr, building custom search facets and index configurations to support fuzzy matching and multilingual content.
- Designed microservices to handle offloaded media transformation and background tasks, integrating them via Drupal queues and custom plugins.
- Ensured data consistency and optimized entity queries using Drupal's EntityQuery API, achieving significant load time improvements on complex Views pages.
- Contributed to internal knowledge base and Drupal best practices documentation, facilitating reusable code patterns and standard onboarding guides.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Developed Drupal-based campaign platforms supporting multi-language content and audience segmentation by building custom taxonomy systems and integrating Apache Solr for search.
- Engineered dynamic web forms with conditional logic and backend validation using Drupal Webform module and custom PHP hooks, supporting over 200,000 submissions/month.
- Refactored legacy PHP and jQuery code into reusable Drupal 9 services and components, reducing maintenance overhead and increasing codebase test coverage by 45%.
- Managed multiple simultaneous Drupal projects across Agile teams, conducting sprint planning, task breakdowns, and code peer reviews while coordinating across time zones.
- Designed content publishing workflows using Workbench Moderation and custom roles/permissions, supporting editorial teams in a decentralized publishing model.
- Implemented role-based JSON REST API endpoints for mobile integration, secured via OAuth2 and token scopes for granular permission enforcement across devices.
- Tuned MySQL queries and indexed large taxonomy datasets, improving editorial page save speeds from 12 seconds to under 2 seconds.
- Conducted technical audits of Drupal codebases, uncovering critical security issues including XSS and CSRF vulnerabilities, and led remediation efforts following Drupal SA standards.

Software Developer
Decima Digital
November 2015 – April 2016
Tallinn, Estonia

- Migrated legacy sites to Drupal 8 using Migrate Plus and Migrate Tools, designing custom YAML-based data mappings and ETL transformations from Excel and XML sources.
- Created secure RESTful APIs for mobile apps interfacing with Drupal entities, implementing throttling, JWT authentication, and custom response serialization.
- Customized Views, Panels, and Paragraphs modules to support modular page design for marketing teams without direct developer intervention.
- Integrated Drupal websites with third-party marketing services such as Mailchimp and HubSpot via contributed modules and custom APIs.
- Refactored monolithic themes into component-based frontends using Pattern Lab and Atomic Design principles for scalability and maintainability.
- Configured Drupal caching layers including render cache and page cache, reducing bounce rates on landing pages by improving page load speeds by 50%.
- Designed and implemented automated backup and rollback processes using Drush and cron jobs, minimizing data loss risk during site updates.
- Assisted with QA automation by writing Behat scenarios and ensuring continuous integration validation via Jenkins pipelines.

Software Developer Intern
Borna Technology
September 2014 – August 2015
Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Contributed to Drupal 7 e-commerce platform by writing PHP hooks, template overrides, and custom modules handling checkout logic and pricing rules.
- Built internal admin dashboards using Views and Rules modules to automate reporting and alert workflows based on real-time order statuses.
- Optimized SQL queries used in product inventory sync, reducing nightly sync job runtime from 3 hours to under 20 minutes.
- Assisted with Drupal security updates and maintenance releases, ensuring compliance with core and module vulnerability advisories.
- Participated in daily standups, sprint reviews, and retrospectives as part of an Agile product team, learning practical Scrum processes.
- Wrote technical documentation and setup guides for new development environments using LAMP stack and Git version control.
- Provided QA support for release candidates, executing manual regression test cases across major browsers and devices.
- Collaborated with UX designers to implement responsive layout fixes using CSS media queries and Sass variables.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ Acquia Certified Drupal Developer – 2023
 - ❖ Advanced PHP Programming Certification – 2022
 - ❖ Secure Web Development (OWASP) – 2021
 - ❖ Agile Project Management – 2020
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PROJECTS

- ✓ **Drupal Migration Suite for Enterprise Clients**
Led a multi-tenant Drupal 9 to 10 migration toolkit supporting custom module compatibility scanning, automated schema updates, and rollback features via Drush CLI.
- ✓ **Headless Drupal API Gateway**
Built a decoupled JSON:API gateway serving React and mobile apps with versioned endpoints, JWT authentication, and GraphQL integration using contributed modules.
- ✓ **Drupal Contribution Tracker**
Created an internal tool to visualize employee Drupal.org contributions, module patches, and issue queue activity using REST and contrib APIs.